

vast majority of people keep most of their thought power centered on their fears, rather than on conceptions and deep beliefs which can bring them what they want—not that of which they are afraid.

Every man can surpass himself. Dr. du Noüy points out dramatically the power of the human being to reach beyond his limitations and thus forever to extend his powers:

We all have our role to play individually. But we only play it well on condition of always trying to do better, of overreaching ourselves. It is this effort which constitutes our personal participation in evolution, our duty. . . . If we have children, we will have collaborated in a measure modestly, statistically, *but unless we develop our personality* we will have left no trace in the true, human evolution. [The italics are mine.]

Obviously Dr. du Noüy recognized the importance of each individual's exercising his privilege of choice in thinking as a means of mental and spiritual growth, for he continues:

"An intelligent being," said Bergson, "carries within him the wherewithal to surpass himself." It is needful for him to know it, and it is essential for him to attempt to realize it. The incomparable gift of brain, with its truly amazing powers of abstraction, has rendered obsolete the slow and sometimes clumsy mechanisms utilized by evolution so far. Thanks to the brain alone, man, in the course of three generations only, has conquered the realm of air, while it took hundreds of thousands of years for animals to achieve the same result through the process of evolution.

Thanks to the brain alone, the range of our sensory organs has been increased a millionfold, far beyond the fondest dreams; we have brought the moon within thirty miles of us [du Noüy is a modern writer, but see how he already needs to be updated!], we see the infinitely small and we see the infinitely remote; we hear the inaudible; we have dwarfed distance and killed physical time.

We have enslaved the forces of the universe, even before we have succeeded in understanding them thoroughly. We have put to shame the tedious and time-consuming methods of trial and error used by nature, because nature has finally succeeded in producing its masterpiece in the shape of the human brain. But the great laws of evolution are still active, even though adaptation has lost its importance as far as we are concerned. We are now responsible for the progress of evolution.

We are free to destroy ourselves if we misunderstand the meaning and the purpose of our victories; and we are free to forge ahead, to prolong evolution, to cooperate with God if we perceive the meaning of it all, if we realize that it can only be achieved through a wholehearted effort toward moral and spiritual development.

Peace of mind and power of mind. Since what you achieve in life depends on what you first conceive, and this depends